

# FILM DOSSIER: IRON MAN 2

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Phase 1 · Film #5

Status: ☒ DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 5 of 29                                                                  |
| Phase                  | Phase 1                                                                  |
| Real title             | <i>IRON MAN 2</i>                                                        |
| Decoy / codename title | <i>"RABBIT HOLE"</i>                                                     |
| Release date           | Friday, May 7, 2010                                                      |
| Distributor            | Paramount Pictures                                                       |
| Director               | Jon Favreau                                                              |
| Rating / runtime       | PG-13 · 158 minutes                                                      |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>addiction drama / espionage thriller</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                           |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK</b> (Iron Man, film 2 of the franchise) |

| Character                                        | Actor                 | Age at release |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------|
| Tony Stark / Iron Man                            | Marc-Anthony Bullock  | 28             |
| Pepper Potts                                     | Tayia Boyd            | 28             |
| Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow                   | Harmony Divine        | 27             |
| Claire Barton / Hawkeye                          | Arianna Cummings      | 27             |
| James "Rhodey" Rhodes                            | Don Cheadle           | 45             |
| The Mandarin                                     | Tony Leung            | 47             |
| Justin Hammer                                    | Sam Rockwell          | 41             |
| Happy Hogan                                      | Jon Favreau           | 43             |
| Nick Fury                                        | Samuel L. Jackson     | 61             |
| Agent Jasper Sitwell                             | Maximiliano Hernández | 36             |
| Stan Lee ( <i>cameo: a Coney Island barker</i> ) | Stan Lee              | 87             |

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <i>"Demon in a Bottle"</i> , <i>Iron Man</i> #120–128 (1979), David Michelinie, Bob Layton & John Romita Jr.: Tony's alcoholism, <b>Justin Hammer's</b> sabotage, and the armor killing a diplomat. <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #50 (February 1964): <b>the Mandarin</b> .                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #52 (April 1964): <b>the Black Widow's</b> first appearance, as a Soviet spy against Iron Man · <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #57 (September 1964): <b>Hawkeye's</b> first appearance. After a misunderstanding at a carnival, the Widow tricks Hawkeye into fighting Iron Man. · <i><b>Iron Man</b></i> #169–170 (1983): <b>Rhodey puts on the Iron Man armor</b> · <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #62 (1965, the Mandarin's origin and the Makluan rings) |
| Nerf check               | ✅ <b>The Mandarin is one of the most powerful villains Iron Man has.</b> All ten rings work at full comic strength, and Tony can't win on his own.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>95%.</b> It combines four landmark storylines. The main change is timing: the Widow and Hawkeye's debut (1964) is paired with "Demon in a Bottle" (1979), and the villains' plots are woven together. |

### Straight from the page:

- **"Demon in a Bottle"**: Tony's drinking spirals. **Justin Hammer** remotely takes over the armor, and **it fires on and kills the ambassador of Carnelia** in public. Tony is disgraced, loses control of his company, and hits bottom. He **gets sober by his own choice**.
- **Justin Hammer**: a smooth, jealous rival arms industrialist (*Iron Man* #120).
- **The Mandarin**: a Chinese genius and martial-arts master who found **ten alien rings** in the wreck of a **Makluan starship** in the **Valley of Spirits** (*ToS* #50, #62).
- **The Black Widow**: a Soviet spy sent to steal Stark technology, seductive, deadly and a master of disguise. On 616 she was trained in the **Red Room** (the later 616 version), and she's a ballet dancer.
- **Hawkeye: Claire Barton**, a carnival sharpshooter raised in **the circus**, sees Iron Man in action at **Coney Island** and decides to become a hero. On her first night out she's **mistaken for a thief**, and **the Black Widow** takes advantage of that and recruits her against Iron Man (*ToS* #57).
- **Rhodey in the armor**: while Tony is out of action, **Rhodey wears the Iron Man armor** in combat (*Iron Man* #169–170). ("Next time, baby" pays off.)
- **The attaché-case armor**: Tony carries a portable armor in a briefcase (Silver Age).

### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Widow and Hawkeye (1964) appear in the same film as "Demon in a Bottle" (1979) | Sliding timescale. It gets both of them established before *The Avengers*, and the Widow's manipulation of Tony adds to his crisis. |

| Hammer and the Mandarin work together | In 616 they were separate threats. Here Hammer is the Mandarin's Western supplier, so the two plots become one. |

| Carnelia's ambassador's death is shown off-screen | PG-13 |

| Hawkeye is Claire Barton | Per the Casting Rules. **She's always been Claire**. Nothing else changes. |

### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character                      | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Shown in this film                                                                                                                     | Held back (why)                                         | Match                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Iron Man (Mark IV)</b>      | Repulsors; uni-beam; supersonic flight; multi-ton strength; sensors; <b>the attaché-case armor</b> (Silver Age)                                                                                                                                                                                                     | All of it, including Tony suiting up from the briefcase in a Monaco hotel corridor                                                     | Later-generation armors (as the comics' models advance) | ✓ 100%                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Tony Stark</b>              | Genius; his addiction is a <b>weakness from the comics, not a nerf</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Designs the Mark IV hungover; sober at the finale                                                                                      | –                                                       | ✓ 100%                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>The Mandarin</b>            | <b>Ten Makluan rings:</b> ice blast, mento-intensifier (mind control), electro-blast, flame blast, white light, black light (darkness), disintegration beam, vortex beam, matter rearranger, impact beam. <b>Master martial artist</b> who can shatter iron by hand. Genius-level scientist. ( <i>ToS</i> #50, #62) | <b>All ten rings are used on screen</b> (each gets a moment), plus hand-to-hand fights where he breaks Iron Man's gauntlet bare-handed | –                                                       | ✓ 100%. <b>It takes Iron Man, Rhodey, and a turned Hawkeye together to force him to retreat. He escapes, as he always does in the comics.</b> |
| <b>Justin Hammer</b>           | Criminal industrialist; hacking and remote-control engineering                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Remotely hijacks Tony's armor                                                                                                          | –                                                       | ✓ 100%                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>The Black Widow</b>         | Peak-human conditioning (the Red Room program); <b>master spy, martial artist, markswoman and seductress; "Widow's Bite"</b> gauntlet stings; wall-crawling suction and a grapple line ( <i>ToS</i> #52 on)                                                                                                         | All of it: she infiltrates Stark Industries as a new executive, fights a Hammer strike team, and uses the Widow's Bite                 | –                                                       | ✓ 100%                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Hawkeye (Claire Barton)</b> | <b>The world's greatest marksman.</b> Peak-human accuracy and reflexes; acrobat; <b>trick arrows:</b> explosive, net, grappling, acid, suction, smoke, electric, sonic ( <i>ToS</i> #57)                                                                                                                            | <b>Every trick arrow on the list.</b> She never misses once in the film, including a shot that splits a thrown knife in midair.        | Her Avengers role (Phase 2)                             | ✓ 100%                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Rhodey (in armor)</b>       | Elite Marine pilot and soldier; fully effective in the armor ( <i>Iron Man</i> #170)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Fights the Mandarin's forces in the Mark III                                                                                           | His own <b>War Machine</b> armor (616, 1992; Phase 2)   | ✓ 100%                                                                                                                                        |

## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | Tony Stark tells the world he's Iron Man, and it nearly kills him. A rival sabotages his armor, a spy works her way into his life, an ancient warlord comes for his technology, and his worst enemy is the bottle. |
| Theme                | <b>Addiction and recovery.</b> The strongest armor in the world can't protect you from yourself.                                                                                                                   |
| Villain / antagonist | <b>The Mandarin</b> (main), <b>Justin Hammer</b> , and <b>the Black Widow and Hawkeye</b> (at first)                                                                                                               |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: THE PRICE OF "I AM IRON MAN"

- **January 2010.** Tony is the most famous man on Earth and falling apart. He's drinking hard and being hauled in front of the Senate, and **Justin Hammer** is testifying against him.
- A striking new executive assistant joins Stark Industries under a cover name. She's **Natasha Romanoff**, the Black Widow, a Soviet-trained spy sent to steal the repulsor designs.
- **Monaco:** Tony suits up from his **attaché-case armor** to stop a Hammer-financed attack at the Grand Prix.

#### ACT TWO: DEMON IN A BOTTLE

- At a United Nations reception, Hammer's hackers **seize control of the armor**. It fires, and **the ambassador of Carnelia is killed**.
- Tony is disgraced. The board forces him out, and the drinking gets much worse.
- **Pepper** tells him the truth. **Rhodey** takes the Mark III: "*Next time, baby.*" This is the next time.
- On **Coney Island**, circus sharpshooter **Claire Barton** stops a robbery, is mistaken for the thief, and runs. The **Widow** is waiting for her with an offer and a lie: *Iron Man is the real criminal*.
- The Widow and Hawkeye attack Tony at his lowest point. **Hawkeye's arrows** take the Mark IV apart.
- The Widow reports to her handler, whose voice on the phone is calm and sounds almost amused. It's **the Mandarin**.

#### ACT THREE: THE TEN RINGS

- Hammer has been **supplying the Mandarin**, who wants Tony's armor technology to bring back his ancient Makluan starship.
- Tony wakes up on a hotel bathroom floor. Pepper is sitting next to him, and he **pours the bottle out**. Day one.
- **The Valley of Spirits, China.** Tony (in a new Mark IV), **Rhodey** (in the Mark III) and **Hawkeye**, who has worked out she was lied to, take on **the Mandarin**.
- All ten rings are in use. The Mandarin is winning.
- **The Widow makes her choice:** she sabotages the Makluan starship's power core from inside.
- The Mandarin **retreats into the mountains**, alive, as he always does.
- Hammer is arrested. The Widow and Hawkeye **disappear** together before S.H.I.E.L.D. arrives.

- Tony gets his company back. The last shot is him at an AA meeting in a church basement: *"My name is Tony. It's been thirty-one days."*

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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Monday, January 11, 2010</b> (the Senate) → <b>Friday, April 16, 2010</b> (the AA meeting). The post-credit scene is on <b>Sunday, April 18, 2010</b> .                                    |
| Where it's set          | <b>Washington, D.C.</b> · <b>Monaco</b> · <b>New York City</b> (UN headquarters, 890 Fifth Avenue, <b>Coney Island</b> ) · <b>the Valley of Spirits, China</b> (filmed in Zhangjiajie, Hunan) |
| Relative to other films | <b>Five months after <i>Ant-Man and the Wasp</i></b> . Tony tells Pepper <i>"Pym's still ignoring my calls."</i>                                                                              |

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## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **Stark after the reveal:** the public hero, the Senate, the rivals.
- **The Mandarin and the Makluan rings**, Iron Man's archenemy.
- **Tony's sobriety**, carried forward for the rest of the saga.
- **Rhodey in armor**, the start of his path to War Machine.

## World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                             | How it appears                                                                                                                              | Payoff                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Black Widow &amp; Hawkeye</b> | Their debut, as antagonists who switch sides and then vanish                                                                                | Phase 2: Hawkeye joins "Cap's Kooky Quartet" ( <i>Avengers</i> #16) and the Widow defects |
| <b>The Red Room</b>              | The Widow's handler file shows a ballet studio in Moscow.                                                                                   | The Widow's Phase 2 story                                                                 |
| <b>S.H.I.E.L.D.</b>              | Sitwell arrives at the Valley of Spirits too late. Fury is angry.                                                                           | <i>The Avengers</i>                                                                       |
| <b>The Avengers Initiative</b>   | Fury gives Tony a file with a Hulk sighting, Blake's hospital file, and a photo of a dollhouse. Tony: " <i>What is this, a book club?</i> " | <i>The Avengers</i>                                                                       |
| <b>Captain America</b>           | The post-credit scene                                                                                                                       | <i>Captain America</i> (2011)                                                             |

## Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed                                          | How it appears                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | What it means                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The first mention of the Infinity Gems</b> | Defeated in the mountains, the Mandarin looks at his rings: " <i>Ten rings. Ten lesser stars. The Makluans told of six jewels older than creation, and a Titan who hunts them. When I find the first, even he will kneel.</i> " | <b>The first time the Infinity Gems are mentioned in the MCU, and the Titan is hunting them.</b> |
| <b>The pattern</b>                            | Titan ( <i>Iron Man</i> ), Titan ( <i>Hulk</i> ), Titan ( <i>Thor</i> ), the golden helmet ( <i>Ant-Man</i> ), and now the jewels                                                                                               | Fans start building the timeline on forums.                                                      |

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## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | <p>✓ "THE ARCHER." On a S.H.I.E.L.D. Helicarrier, <b>Fury</b> watches security footage from the Valley of Spirits. Claire Barton puts an arrow through a gap in the Mandarin's energy shield half an inch wide.</p> <p><b>FURY:</b> "Get me the archer."</p> <p><b>SITWELL:</b> "And the Widow?"</p> <p><b>FURY:</b> "The Widow will come to us."</p>                                                                                                 |
| Post-credit scene      | <p>✓ "STILL LOOKING." Fury's private office, at night. A framed <b>WWII photograph</b>: a young <b>Sgt. Nick Fury</b> with the <b>Howling Commandos</b>, and in the middle, <b>a young man with a star on his chest and a round shield</b>. Fury studies it, then looks at a map of the <b>North Atlantic</b> covered in crossed-off search grids.</p> <p><b>FURY</b> (quietly): "Sixty-five years, Cap. I'm still looking." <b>CUT TO BLACK.</b></p> |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: " <b>SECURITY REVIEW.</b> " Post-credit: " <b>FAMILY PHOTO.</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline